Vaibhav Sabnis

Senior Technologist | Distributed Systems, ML Infrastructure & Platform Reliability

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Executive Summary

Seasoned technologist with 20+ years of experience building and scaling high-performance distributed systems, machine learning infrastructure, and developer platforms.

- Led global multi-layer organizations ranging from early-stage 0→1 platform initiatives to engineering divisions of 125+ personnel across infrastructure, big data platforms, developer productivity, and high-throughput transactional systems.
- Proven track record of driving cross-department infrastructure modernization, engineering efficiency, and platform reliability strategies across globally distributed engineering teams handling trillions in transaction throughput.
- Deep technical background in performance-critical backend architectures, custom compilers/runtimes, and cloud-native systems, including the enterprise-scale adoption of LLM-assisted coding platforms and agentic developer workflows.

Core Competencies & Technology Domain

- Engineering Leadership: 3-5 Year Tech Strategy, Org Design (125+ FTEs), Global Location Strategy, Buy-vs-Build Choices, Developer Efficiency Metrics, Capital Budgeting.
- Distributed Infrastructure & Cloud: High-Availability Systems, Low-Latency/HPC Compute, Cloud-Native Architecture (Azure/AWS), Microservices, High-Throughput APIs, DevSecOps, Platform Observability (PREQ).
- Product & Data Platforms: Product Infrastructure Strategy, Data Engineering & Governance, High-Throughput Transaction Processing, Cash Management Systems, Billing & Reconciliation Platforms.
- Developer Productivity: Agentic Coding Platforms Integrations, Enterprise IDE Tooling, Automated Engineering Workflows, Inner-Source SDLC Frameworks
- Data & AI/ML Engineering: ML Production Readiness, Distributed Data Engines (Spark/Presto), LLM Agentic Workflows, ML Model Evaluation and Explainability, Document Content Extraction Pipelines (NLP/OCR), Model Governance.

Work Experience

Meta | NYC (June 2021 – Present): Software Engineering Manager – Ads ML Data Infra & Messaging Reliability

- Scaled a 0→1 globally distributed 40+ person engineering organization from inception, spanning multiple engineering managers and senior ICs; owned organizational planning, global hiring strategies, and multi-year technical roadmaps.
- Orchestrated cross-functional execution across dozens of cross-functional partners and teams, aligning complex engineering strategies across foundational infrastructure and consumer-facing product groups.
- Safeguarded $1.4B+ in annual ads revenue by directing the strategy and delivery of an ML observability and explainability platform focused on Performance, Reliability, Efficiency, and Quality (PREQ), reducing critical failure detection and mitigation latency from weeks to minutes.
- Redesigned agentic workflows from human-in-the-loop to fully autonomous human-on-the-loop execution, cutting developer overhead by 70% through targeted IDE integrations and automated evaluation pipelines.
- Tech: C++, Python, Scribe, Presto, Hive/Spark, AI/Agentic: MetaMate, DevMate (MuseSpark), Claude, Codex

Goldman Sachs | NYC (Oct 2020 – June 2021): Executive Director – Core Platform Engineering, Global Markets Division

- Assumed leadership of a 30-person engineering organization across platform, quantitative, and distributed compute engineering, stabilizing delivery during a strategic legacy-to-cloud transition phase.

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- Accelerated the cloud-native migration roadmap for SecDB (core real-time risk platform), moving the project from discovery to the initial execution phase of migrating the monolithic on-prem infrastructure to distributed cloud architecture.
- Unblocked performance bottlenecks in the HPC environment by directing a targeted sprint to optimize custom compilers and low-level memory allocation, improving compute throughput for OTC pricing and risk trading infrastructure.
- Tech: Slang, C++, Python, Linux, hybrid cloud-native clusters, HPC environments

Morgan Stanley | New York (Jan 2006 – Oct 2020): Executive Director – Morgan Stanley Fund Services (MSFS) & Prime Brokerage Technology

Global Head of Investor Data Engineering (2011 - 2020)

- Led a global multi-layered engineering organization of 125+ engineers, managers, and technical leads responsible for cloud-native platforms, investor transaction systems, data infrastructure, and regulatory technology supporting Morgan Stanley Fund Services and Prime Brokerage operations managing 700+ Bn AUM.
- Contributed to 7% YoY topline business revenue growth by building high-performance engineering teams to modernize fraud detection, franchise risk analysis, and API-first platform architectures.
- Automated 150+ FTEs of manual business operations capacity by centralizing and scaling fragmented legacy data systems into distributed, sub-second latency microservices processing millions of global investor transactions.
- Reduced enterprise operational overhead by 10% YoY through the deployment of automated ML, OCR, and NLP based pipelines that eliminated manual document scraping for transaction risk monitoring and content classifications.
- Tech: Java, Kotlin, Spring Boot, WebSockets, Azure, OpenNLP, OCR pipelines, DevOps

Founding Core Software Engineer (2006 – 2011)

- Served as founding engineer for proprietary distributed transaction processing, reconciliation, cash and payment management infrastructure that significantly improved transaction integrity, and operational efficiency workflows helping achieve >90% automated trade break resolutions.
- Designed and engineered complex transaction-matching algorithms and on-demand investor K-1 tax allocation system to compute wash sales that enabled front-office to execute tax-optimal trades and support US regulatory requirements.
- Phased out legacy third-party vendor licensing costs through the development of highly customized, internal tax and economic accounting systems, driving a 30% improvement in revenue collections
- Tech: Java, Sybase, algorithmic transaction engines, portfolio NAV proprietary systems

Early Career History & Education

- Early Career History (2001 – 2006): Software Programmer with Mastek Ltd. (UK) delivering distributed migrations in insurance and aerospace domains | Engineering Intern at IIT Bombay focusing on VoIP/SIP protocols for Microsoft-backed research projects.
- Education: Bachelor of Engineering in Electronics & Telecommunication (June 1998 – June 2002) – First Class with Distinction, Mumbai University, India.

Technical Skills Matrix

- System Architecture: Distributed Infrastructure, Cloud-Native Architecture, HPC, DevOps, Platform Observability
- Programming Languages: Java, Python, C++, Spring Boot, WebSockets, Linux Systems
- Platforms & Tools: Presto, Hive, Spark, Scribe, OpenNLP, OCR, AI Agents (MuseSpark, OpenClaw, Claude, Codex)